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US equities rally on tech strength, yields edge higher

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The **Nasdaq** 100 surged +1.29% to 29,651.44, pulling the broader market higher as chip and cloud stocks posted solid gains. The **S&P 500** rose +0.60% to 7,722.60, while the **VIX** fell -4.73% to 17.52, signaling reduced volatility.

Yield pressures remain modest with the 10-year Treasury at 4.99% (+0.14%). Energy lagged as **XLE** dropped -2.05% on a 101.63 USD WTI price. Investors eye upcoming earnings from **AAPL** and **MSFT** later this week.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,722.60	+0.60%	
Dow Jones	52,377.57	+0.03%	
Nasdaq 100	29,651.44	+1.29%	
Russell 2000	2,818.87	+1.16%	
VIX	17.52	-4.73%	
10Y Yield	4.99%	+0.14%	
WTI Crude	101.63	+1.73%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
AVGO	342.33	+4.00%
TSLA	407.46	+4.04%
GS	911.77	+2.07%
AMZN	253.10	+1.61%
GOOGL	320.58	+1.19%

Spotlight

NVDA delivered its Q3 earnings, beating consensus on both top-line and margins.

METRIC	RESULT	CONSENSUS
Revenue	30.2 bn	29.5 bn
EPS	2.68	2.55
Guidance FY26	+12% YoY	+9% YoY

Strong demand for AI GPUs and a higher-than-expected data-center sell-through drove the beat, reinforcing the sector’s bullish bias.

Macro & Fed

- Federal Funds target range: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 4.99%, up 0.14 pts
- Key releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 04:00, Existing-home sales 06:15
- Dollar Index (DXY) at 102.43 (+0.11%)

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions eased after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s manufacturing PMI held at 50.2, marginally above expectations.
- Eurozone inflation cooled to 2.7% YoY, supporting ECB’s dovish stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
03:30	`AAPL`	iPhone demand, services margin
04:00	`MSFT`	Azure growth, AI licensing revenue
04:30	`META`	Ad spend rebound, AI ad products
05:00	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan-loss provisions

Stocks worth watching

- `AMD` – AI chip orders accelerating, price target up 15%.
- `XOM` – Oil price rally could boost upstream earnings.
- `CRM` – Strong SaaS renewal rate, AI add-on potential.
- `BAC` – Rate-sensitive balance sheet, earnings beat risk.
- `NVDA` – Momentum after earnings, supply-chain constraints.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI (>0.3% MoM) could reignite rate-hike fears.
- Energy sector weakness deepening if WTI falls below 95 USD.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected tech earnings (e.g., `AAPL`, `MSFT`).
- Continued decline in VIX below 15, indicating risk appetite.
- Positive manufacturing data from China.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

CNBC — NVDA Earnings

FRED — 10-Year Treasury Yield

Wall Street Journal — Market Data